so peaceful from a distance that I wonder where al those boundaries are which separate district from district, state from state, and country from country. Maybe such a sense of distance and detachment is required in dealing with al the activities of our life.

Since the Interim Test Range at Balasore was stil at least a year away from completion, we had set up special facilities at SHAR for the launch of Prithvi. These included a launch pad, block house, control consoles and mobile telemetry stations. I had a happy reunion with my old friend MR Kurup who was the Director, SHAR Centre by then. Working with Kurup on the Prithvi launch campaign gave me great satisfaction. Kurup worked for Prithvi as a team member, ignoring the boundary lines that divide DRDO and ISRO, DRDL and SHAR. Kurup used to spend a lot of time with us at the launch pad. He complemented us with his experience in range testing and range safety and worked with great enthusiasm in propel ant fil ing, making the maiden Prithvi launch campaign a memorable experience.

Prithvi was launched at 11:23 hrs on 25 February 1988. It was an epoch-making event in the history of rocketry in the country. Prithvi was not merely a surface-to-surface